

Deploy to Render

1. Push to GitHub

```
git add .
git commit -m "Add free-tier Render blueprint"
git push origin main
```

2. Create the services

- 1 dashboard.render.com > **New** > **Blueprint**
- 2 Pick your repository.
- 3 Set **Blueprint file** to render-free.yaml — not render.yaml, which is paid.
- 4 **Apply**. Expect 3 free services and no price. Wait for the build.

3. Check the API

Open <https://servorabd-api.onrender.com/healthz/> — expect {"status": "ok", "database": "ok"}. First load takes ~50s while the service wakes.

4. Seed the data

Copy the **External Database URL** from **servorabd-db**, then from backend/:

```
$env:DATABASE_URL = "<External Database URL>"
$env:DJANGO_SETTINGS_MODULE = "config.settings.prod"
$env:SECRET_KEY = "one-off"
python manage.py seed_catalogue
python manage.py createsuperuser
```

5. Fix the rewrites if renamed

If Render named your API anything other than servorabd-api, edit the four destination lines in render-free.yaml to the real hostname, then push. Otherwise the site loads but no data arrives.

6. Add SMTP if people must log in

Login codes are e-mailed. Without these four keys the site works but **nobody can register or log in**. Set them on **servorabd-api** > **Environment** (Gmail needs an app password, not your normal one):

Key	Value
EMAIL_HOST	smtp.gmail.com
EMAIL_HOST_USER	your Gmail address
EMAIL_HOST_PASSWORD	16-char app password, no spaces
DEFAULT_FROM_EMAIL	same Gmail address

7. Verify the site

At <https://servorabd-web.onrender.com>: the landing page loads, /providers loads with data, and /admin/ shows a **styled** Django login.

8. Set a 30-day reminder

The free database is **deleted after 30 days** and cannot be upgraded in place. Before then, dump it and move to `render.yaml`:

```
pg_dump --format=custom --no-owner \
  --dbname="<External Database URL>" --file=servorabd.dump
```

If something breaks

Symptom	Cause
First visit takes ~50s	Free service waking. Expected.
Lists are empty	seed_catalogue not run (step 4).
No login code arrives	No SMTP (step 6).
Site loads, no data	Rewrite hostname wrong (step 5).
Deep link 404s	Missing /* rewrite to app.html.
/admin/ unstyled	collectstatic failed; check build log.
Bad Request (400)	Set ALLOWED_HOSTS to your API hostname.
DB errors after ~a month	Free database expired (step 8).
Uploads vanish on deploy	No persistent disk on free. Expected.

Not running on free

Cron services need a paid plan, so the seven scheduled jobs never fire: bookings will not auto-expire and reviews will not auto-reveal. Run one by hand with the step 4 variables set:

```
python manage.py run_scheduled_jobs --only reveal_reviews
```